

Chapter 67 - In Vain

Feng Yue and Xu Yan's faces, even if placed in the entertainment industry, would be able to stand on their own. So after they finished walking the red carpet and entered the main venue, the live broadcast director seemed to have found the traffic code¹, frantically giving the camera to their position.

The live broadcast room was split half and half between passersby and fans of tonight's performing guests. Naturally, this approach by the director caused dissatisfaction among those celebrity fans.

The ones jumping the highest were naturally the fans of Chu An'an, who had just debuted in the C position². The entire live broadcast room was filled with smoke and chaos, completely a fan-black war³.

However, online matters couldn't affect the on-site personnel at all. The director's head was also very stubborn - no matter how much the live broadcast room cursed, the camera still frequently went to Feng Yue and Xu Yan's position.

Feng Yue was completely unaware of all this. She and Xu Yan sat in their seats without speaking, but were lost in thought about something.

Feng Yue and their seats were in the middle section. In front of them were the executives of Cat Station Video⁴ and today's performing guest seats.

Yan Lin's back was not far in front of her, while Chu An'an was sitting with her team members in a position diagonally behind and to the left of Yan Lin.

Feng Yue thought expressionlessly that fate was probably just this wonderful. In her previous life, she could only watch these two people's story from outside the book. This time, she could only gaze at them from behind these two people.

In their story, there would never be her.

She, Feng Yue, was just a supporting character with a predetermined death date.

Feng Yue stared ahead blankly, but her gaze had no focal point, so naturally she didn't notice Yan Lin suddenly standing up.

Yan Lin stood up with the things Chang Ya had bought, walking backward. Her target was naturally Feng Yue sitting behind.

The live broadcast camera was still on Feng Yue's side, and Yan Lin just directly entered the camera shot like this.

She was clear about the current situation in the live broadcast room. Those eyes, calm as an ancient well, glanced at the camera.

At the same time, the live broadcast audience saw the director finally cut the camera to someone else.

Yan Lin's arrival caught Feng Yue off guard, but Yan Lin also had no intention of staying long. She just crouched beside Feng Yue, handed her the things in her hand, and said: "I just saw that your complexion didn't look too good, so I had someone buy some candy. Eat some first."

Yan Lin was afraid that Feng Yue's low blood sugar wouldn't be able to withstand the long wait that followed.

As soon as Yan Lin said this, even Xu Yan beside her looked at her sideways.

If she remembered correctly, Feng Yue and Yan Lin should have divorced, right? So what performance was this now?

Xu Yan's gaze was subtle, but Yan Lin directly stood up and prepared to leave after delivering the candy.

Feng Yue looked at the large bag of candy placed on her lap - it was the brand she had eaten before.

Feng Yue knew that Yan Lin was showing goodwill toward her, but she now only felt it was meaningless.

"Yan Lin." Feng Yue looked up and called out.

Yan Lin turned around, thinking Feng Yue had something to tell her.

Feng Yue looked at that face she had loved for more than ten years, and a sense of powerlessness surged from the bottom of her heart. She weighed the candy in her hand and said lightly: "This is meaningless."

Yan Lin thought she was saying that what she was doing was meaningless. Her face instantly became much uglier. "As long as I'm willing, these things are meaningful." After saying this, Yan Lin looked away, not daring to look at Feng Yue's expression anymore.

Only Feng Yue knew that the real meaning of her words was that she and Yan Lin could never be together, so doing these things to seek a result that didn't exist at all was completely useless effort.

Feng Yue knew she had misunderstood, but she didn't explain further. "Thank you for the candy. The awards ceremony is about to start."

Yan Lin knew that Feng Yue's words were urging her to leave. She pressed her lips together, left behind "I'll go first," and then turned and left.

Feng Yue lowered her head and stared at the bag of candy for a while, then blinked and tore open the candy, sharing some with Xu Yan.

She tore open the orange-flavored hard candy and put it in her mouth. The moderately sweet and sour taste spread on her tongue, making her mouth water.

She did indeed have a bit of low blood sugar, so this bag of candy really made her feel much better.

The awards ceremony started on time, and the entire process proceeded in an orderly manner, until they reached the "Cat Station's Top Ten New Blogger Awards," when they finally called Feng Yue's name.

Feng Yue had never earned a penny from making videos, and had actually spent quite a bit of her own money. So this award was probably the best recognition she had received during her time making videos, and also her only substantial gain.

Naturally, she was very happy to receive this award, so the smile on her face didn't seem fake either.

She stood on the award platform, with bloggers who had also received trophies beside her. The audience below was in darkness, but she could see Yan Lin's familiar face in that darkness.

The other person sat in the front row close to the award platform, and the dazzling stage lights seemed to also sprinkle some on her.

Those eyes quietly gazed at Feng Yue, with undisguised joy in their depths, and a difficult-to-hide smile appeared on her usually calm face.

The two looked at each other from afar, and suddenly Yan Lin moved her lips, silently mouthing a few words.

She said: "A Yue, congratulations."

Feng Yue's gaze dodged to the side, her heart filled with indescribable feelings, so she could only focus on the matter at hand.

Feng Yue happily received the trophy and bouquet from the award presenter, waiting for her upcoming speech.

But just as she received the bouquet, she discovered that her flowers seemed different from everyone else's.

What she held in her arms were the most familiar and favorite roses⁵ she knew.

Feng Yue looked at other people's flowers in disbelief. Those flowers were indeed beautiful, but most were roses and lilies.

Only hers, only what she held in her hands was a bouquet of pure bright red roses.

Feng Yue didn't think this was a staff error. Among all the people present, only one person knew she liked roses.

Feng Yue looked toward the audience again. That person was still looking at her with pride and joy, just as before.

When she discovered that she was looking over, she was surprised for a moment, then smiled faintly again.

Before Feng Yue could think much more, it was her turn to speak.

She held the trophy in one hand and the bouquet in the other, and could only bow slightly to get close to the microphone.

"Hello everyone, I'm blogger Six-Inch Moon. First, thank you to the officials for giving me this award..." Feng Yue said a polite section of thanks, then continued, "This award is the first award in my blogging career. I hope I can carry everyone's expectations and continue forward, and not let it become the last award..."

This last part sounded like the most ordinary words of self-encouragement to everyone, but it sounded somewhat abnormal to Yan Lin's ears.

She didn't understand whether Feng Yue's words were just casual talk, but thinking of Feng Yue's state today, she felt somewhat uneasy.

It was as if Feng Yue was a butterfly perched on a branch ready to spread its wings, with the possibility of flying far away from her at any time.

This was an urgency and panic that Yan Lin had never experienced before. She thought for a moment and gestured for Chang Ya to come over.

"Get me the surveillance footage as soon as possible. You handle the follow-up matters with Cat Station Video and Wang's side. I need to go to Germany again tomorrow."

"Yes, President Yan." Chang Ya nodded in agreement and conveniently booked the earliest flight to Germany for tomorrow for Yan Lin.

Yan Lin was still worried about Feng Yue. Since Feng Yue couldn't go to Germany with her to see Wendell, then she would go bring Wendell back to the country.

After Feng Yue finished receiving her award and came down from the stage, because going up and down the stage required passing through the backstage, which was relatively dark and crowded, Feng Yue stumbled when someone bumped into her while walking.

"Sorry."

"Excuse me."

Both said at the same time.

Feng Yue looked up and discovered that the person who bumped into her was an acquaintance.

Chu An'an was following behind her teammates, only focused on talking with her teammates and didn't notice the people beside her.

The two looked at each other, and Chu An'an recognized this as the person who had stared at her at the bathroom door earlier.

Thinking of how this person had inexplicably stared at her just now, Chu An'an's expression also turned cold.

"Sorry for bumping into you." The young girl's tone was cold and hard, with no trace of apology to be heard.

Feng Yue looked at her with extremely complex emotions in her eyes. When she had seen Chu An'an's photos before, she knew the other party was very beautiful.

But seeing her again now, she discovered that Chu An'an's appearance was indeed worthy of her current popularity throughout the internet.

This wasn't without the credit of entertainment company packaging, but fundamentally it was because the other party had good foundation.

She and Yan Lin standing together should be a good match.

After Chu An'an perfunctorily apologized, she followed the staff's arrangements to go wait backstage, while Feng Yue naturally returned to her seat.

Her appearance wasn't the type that was stunning at first sight, but rather the type that became more attractive the more you looked - like a gentle, flowing stream.

So when people in the circle learned that she and Yan Lin were married, they were all shocked.

Because Yan Lin was that kind of perfect "other people's child."

Whether in appearance or ability, every aspect was outstanding. In their eyes, Feng Yue was merely at a "not bad, okay" level.

Plus, they didn't have a wedding ceremony when they got married, so everyone didn't really recognize Feng Yue's identity as "Mrs. Yan."

But now it was different.

If it was someone like Chu An'an standing with Yan Lin, someone so dazzling. Probably no one would have any more criticisms.

Feng Yue thought carefully, but her nails unconsciously started scratching at the trophy in her hand.

Xu Yan watched her for a while. Seeing that she was about to scratch her nails raw, she reached out and pressed down on Feng Yue's hand, frowning and whispering: "Hey, Feng Yue! What's wrong with you? You've been acting strange since this afternoon."

Feng Yue's thoughts were interrupted, and she suddenly came back to her senses. Seeing Xu Yan's unfriendly expression, she looked down at her hands being held down, only then realizing what she had been doing.

The dull pain from her fingertips made Feng Yue's hands tremble slightly. She swallowed and breathed out, forcing a smile, "Thank you. I, I was just too absorbed in thinking about something, so I didn't notice."

Hearing this, Xu Yan withdrew her hand and said: "Anyway, there's nothing more for us later. If you're not feeling well, we can leave early."

Feng Yue nodded, her eyelids trembling slightly, "Okay. Let's go back then."

The two got up and left their seats. Qian He was waiting for them in the previous rest room.

The three left the convention center early. After saying goodbye to Qian He and Xu Yan, Feng Yue drove home alone. However, this time she didn't go back to her parents' place, but returned to Song He Bay.

Feng Yue dragged her tired body to open the door, then leaned back against the door panel and slowly slid down to sit on the floor.

The house had no lights on, and darkness enveloped that small figure.

Back home, Feng Yue could no longer bear the enormous mental pressure and began to sob quietly.

Feng Yue was someone who had died once, but at this moment, learning that all her struggles and self-salvation were in vain, she completely broke down.

"Why... why do this to me..."

Footnotes:

1. **Traffic code (流量密码)** - Chinese internet slang referring to content or strategies that reliably generate high viewership/engagement
2. **C position (C位出道)** - The center position in a group, typically reserved for the most popular or skilled member; "C位" comes from "center position"
3. **Fan-black war (粉黑大战)** - Chinese internet term for battles between fans and anti-fans (people who actively dislike a celebrity)
4. **Cat Station Video (猫站视频)** - A fictional video platform in the story, similar to real Chinese platforms like Bilibili
5. **Roses (月季)** - The Chinese term "月季" specifically refers to Chinese roses or monthly roses, which bloom repeatedly throughout the growing season